

What do the tree numbers prove?

Comino's removal, transplant and replacement plan, checked against the evidence

THE CLAIM

“54 protected trees will be removed”
“540 new indigenous trees”

Environment and Resources Authority, 11 August 2026

Comino · planned removals, planting and transplantation

These are announced conditions, not measured outcomes.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*Math checks out;
outcome unmeasured.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

678

specimens for removal

ERA's categories: 624 non-protected plus 54 protected.

92.04%

non-protected share

624 of 678; rounds to the stated 92%.

540

new indigenous trees

Ten for each of the 54 protected trees scheduled for removal.

348

trees to transplant

Separate from removal; ERA says 341 are protected. Failures trigger a further 10:1 condition.

Not shown

ecological offset

No public survival or habitat-recovery results for these Comino trees were available at review.

FAIR TO SAY

The counts and ratios in ERA's published plan reconcile. That supports the factual description, while leaving species-level ecological replacement and transplant success to be measured.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Publish the complete species and condition schedule.

☐ Publish the final species, provenance and aftercare plan.

☐ Report transplant and planting survival at years 1, 3 and 5.

☐ Monitor native biodiversity and habitat function, not counts alone.